

COVENANT EYES ONLY – FIELD COPY

CASE BRIEF – OPERATION CRUCIBLE

Case Designation:

Operation Crucible

Region:

Central Europe (CSSR, Austria, BRD)

Classification:

Secret – CL 2+

Issuing Division:

Wayfinder – Research Wing

Date:

[Current Date]

SITUATION

An artifact designated "**The Crucifix of St. Vitus**" (see attached Relic Summary) has been stolen from the Prague Castle chapel museum. The theft was not discovered by local authorities – a forgery was substituted. A Covenant routine audit detected an anomalous Corruption signature in Vienna, triggering this case. The artifact is an iron crucifix historically associated with Count Jaroslav Bořita of Martinice, who survived the 1618 Defenestration of Prague. Covenant analysis suggests the survival was not miraculous – the crucifix possesses properties that render its wearer immune to bodily harm.

OBJECTIVES

- Primary:** Locate and recover the Crucifix of St. Vitus. Contain in a Keep vault under standard Tier 2 protocols.
- Secondary:** Identify the theft crew and the party or parties brokering or bidding on the artifact.
- Tertiary:** Determine whether additional fragments of the source material exist and, if so, secure or seal the origin site.

KNOWN ORGANIZATIONS

ORGANIZATION	POSTURE	ASSESSMENT
The Theft Crew	Active – moving the artifact	Professional. At least one member has tested the crucifix and confirmed its effect.
Vantablack Compact	Active – brokering	Likely brokering a private sale. The Compact rarely acquires for its own use; expect a buyer.

Catholic Church (Congregation for the Doctrine of the Faith)	Active – independent recovery	Deployed own team. Cardinal Voss is the lead. Assume they will not coordinate.
The Buyer	Unconfirmed	Identity unknown. Compact is protecting the client. Known meeting occurred at Zurich private airport.

INITIAL LEADS

1. **Prague Castle Chapel Museum (L1):** The theft site. The forgery is still on display. Examine the forgery for craftsmanship clues. Interview museum staff about the substitution timeline.
2. **Countess Martinice, Brno (L2):** Last surviving descendant of the Martinice family. The crucifix was in her family for generations before being donated. She may know its history – and its origin.
3. **Vienna First District (L3):** The Corruption signature spiked at an antiquities gallery for 90 minutes. Someone was testing the artifact there.
4. **Munich (L4):** The signature was steady for three days at a bank vault. The crucifix was stored there between showings.

OPERATIONAL PARAMETERS

- **Rules of Engagement:** Standard artifact recovery. Minimize civilian exposure. The artifact's bearer cannot be harmed by physical force – do not attempt lethal engagement. Containment requires removal of the crucifix from the bearer's person.
- **Church Protocol:** Cardinal Voss's team operates under ecclesiastical authority. Do not engage them as hostile unless they initiate. Do not share Covenant intelligence. They are a parallel operation, not an allied one.
- **Compact Protocol:** The Vantablack Compact is a criminal organization. Interdiction of Compact operatives is authorized but not at the expense of the primary objective.
- **Shrine Site:** If investigation reveals the origin site of the crucifix's source material, report coordinates to HQ immediately. Do not extract material without authorization.

REGIONAL CONTACTS

CONTACT	LOCATION	ACCESS
Dr. Helena Novák, Charles University	Prague	Medieval metallurgy specialist. Covenant affiliate. Can analyze the forgery.

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Case Brief Player — The Heavenly Crucifix

Father Michal, St. Vitus Cathedral	Prague	Sympathetic priest. Aware of the Covenant's existence. Can provide Church access.
Inspector Radim Svoboda, Czech Police	Prague	Not Covenant. Not compromised. Will investigate a theft if given evidence. Useful if the Church oversteps.

This briefing contains information classified at Clearance Level 2. Distribution outside the assigned cell requires Watch Commander authorization. The artifact summary attached is a field estimate only – full Relic Sheet is DA-access.